

Nikhela Motha de Silva



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EDUCATION

Chapman University, Bachelor of Science in Data Science

Expected 2028

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Orca IQ

Co-Founder & Project Manager

Seattle, Washington

May 2026 - Present

- Coordinated project timelines, workflows, and team assignments for AI-assisted orca research.
- Managed drone footage labeling, data collection, and quality control across team projects.
- Collaborated with researchers and interns to streamline data workflows and support conservation research.

InfinitiOne Investment Banking

Data Intelligence Intern

Remote

May 2025 - August 2025

- Created and scheduled engaging social media content while consistently monitoring engagement across multiple platforms.
- Assisted with accurate data collection, performance analysis, and reporting to support marketing initiatives and strategy.
- Tracked campaign performance metrics and compiled insights to optimize content strategy and improve audience engagement.

Map-Collective

Data Science Intern

Washington DC

Oct 2023 - January 2024

- Analyzed 10+ marketing metrics across multiple campaigns to identify trends and support data-driven decisions.
- Created detailed reports and presented key insights to leadership, including the CEO and SVP.
- Monitored social media performance and supported ongoing data collection to improve engagement.

Wild Orca

Research Assistant

San Juan Island, Washington

May 2023 - October 2023

- Collected SRKW scat samples and conducted field research to analyze stress, nutrition, and migration patterns in wild populations.
- Performed data entry, statistical analysis, and photo identification to support long-term population tracking and research accuracy.
- Wrote detailed field reports and represented the organization at public-facing educational outreach and community events.

The Center for Whale Research

Drone Pilot Intern

Friday Harbor, Washington

May 2021 - August 2021

- Piloted drones to capture high-resolution aerial data on SRKW behavior and ecology for research analysis purposes.
- Collaborated closely with research team to expand photo and video documentation efforts for conservation studies.
- Maintained full compliance with FAA Part 107 regulations during all drone flight operations and field activities.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Vail Resorts

Rental Technician

Vail, Colorado

January 2024 - April 2024

- Assisted 50+ customers daily with equipment fitting and recommendations based on skill level and individual needs assessment.
- Performed tuning, maintenance, and precise adjustments on ski and snowboard equipment to ensure optimal performance and safety.
- Delivered high-quality customer service in a fast-paced, high-volume retail environment while maintaining efficiency and professionalism.

Mike's Cafe and Wine Bar

Dishwasher

Friday Harbor, Washington

October 2023

- Maintained consistent kitchen cleanliness and organization in a fast-paced, high-volume commercial environment.
- Supported overall team efficiency through timely dishwashing, restocking, and workspace upkeep duties.
- Ensured strict compliance with sanitation and safety standards in accordance with health regulations.

SKILLS & DISTINCTIONS

- Soft Skills: Professional Communication, Problem-Solving, Analytical Thinking, Adaptability, & Audio Engineering
- Computer: Ability to code in Java, Python, and C++, Data Entry & Analysis, Writing & Communication
- Certifications: FAA Part 107 Remote Pilot Certificate